11 Making a Difference

Warm up

In groups, discuss what you think each sign is asking you to do. Have you seen any of these signs before? Where do you think we should put these signs up? Draw pictures of similar signs that you may have seen. Share your ideas and pictures with the class.

Let's read about two children who realized one day that they also needed to do something to help the environment.

Madhu and her brother Mehul walked home dejectedly. This was unusual because they usually walked home exchanging lively notes on the lessons they had each learnt at school that day.

They walked quietly, side by side, not saying anything. When a lady walked by with her dog, Madhu did not stop to pet it as she would have otherwise done. When they passed the ice candy man, Mehul did not run to him even though he had the money he had earned from washing his father's scooter. Their bags seemed heavier today; the road to home seemed longer.

What was unusual about the way Madhu and Mehul walked home that day?

When they got home, their parents were in the kitchen. They had made *maddur vada* and *chiroti*. Even this did not excite Madhu and Mehul.

"What is the matter?" asked their mother. "Have you two been quarrelling?"

"No, Amma," said Mehul.

"Did you have a difficult day at school? Is there anything I can do to help?" asked their father.

dejectedly: in an unhappy and disappointed manner maddur vada: crispy snacks that are fried and served with tea in Karnataka chiroti: a dessert made from fried dough quarrelling: arguing Amma: mother in Kannada

"No, Appa," replied Madhu. "Unfortunately, there is nothing you can do to help."

"That's just it," piped up Mehul. "Something very wrong has happened and there is nothing we can do about it."

Find a word that means 'began to speak'.

"Why don't you tell us about it?" said their mother.

"Today we had a science club meeting to discuss our environment," said Madhu. "And we learnt that people are polluting our environment and destroying our beautiful planet. Our teacher asked us to think of something we could each do, to protect the planet. Though we've thought and thought, it seems like too much damage is being done and nothing we do will ever make a difference."

What had the teacher asked the children to do?

Why were the children upset?

Their mother sat quietly for a minute, thinking. "I am glad to see that you are both concerned about our environment," she said. "And I understand how helpless you must feel when you think about all the damage that has been done. So let me tell you a story that your grandfather told me. I don't know where he heard it, but I think that it might help you think about your problem in a different way.

"One morning a man was walking down a beach. The beach was covered with dying starfish. The previous night, the tide had been especially strong. So, thousands of starfish had been washed up on the shore. The fish were washed up too far up for them to make it back into the water by themselves. The man shook his head as he trudged along, thinking what a shame it was that all of those starfish would die on the beach.

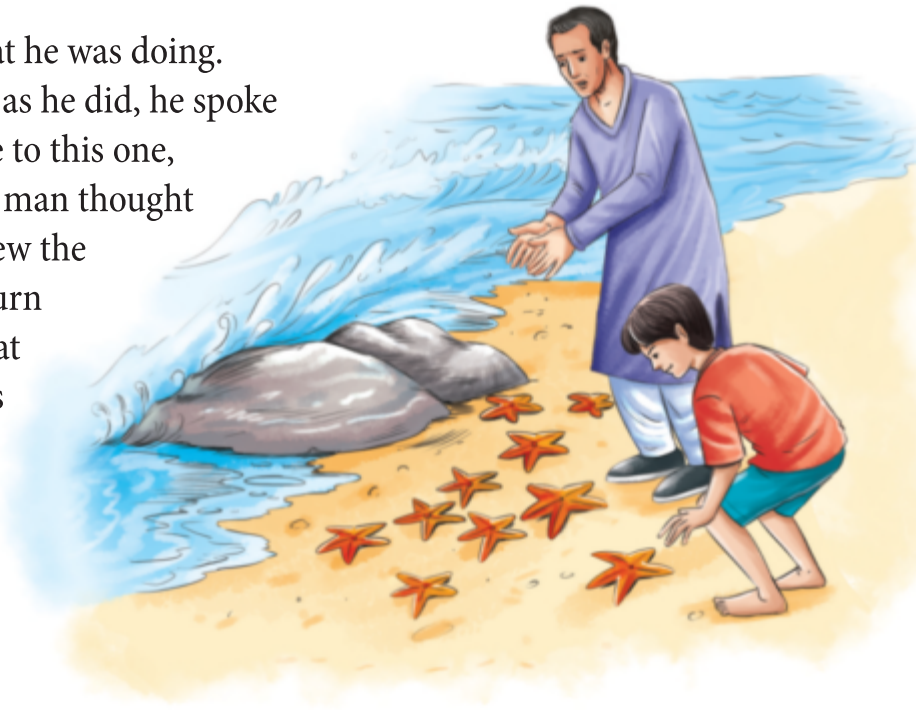
"He came upon a boy who was throwing the starfish back into the ocean as fast as he could. The boy was out of breath, and it was obvious that he had been at this task for a while.

Appa: father in Kannada concerned: worried helpless: not able to do things without help starfish: a flat sea creature in the shape of a star with five arms tide: regular rise and fall in the level of the sea, caused by the pull of the moon and the sun out of breath: having difficulty breathing obvious: easy to understand

'Son,' the man said, 'you might as well quit. There are thousands of them. They are washed up all over the beach as far as you can see. There is no way you can make any sort of a difference.'

Why was the boy out of breath?

"The boy did not even pause in what he was doing. He kept bending and throwing, but as he did, he spoke to the man, 'I can make a difference to this one, and this one, and this one.' And the man thought about what the boy said, and he knew the boy was right. He began to help return the animals to their home, smiling at how life's biggest lessons sometimes came from the smallest people."



Madhu and Mehul listened with rapt attention.

"The boy did make a difference, didn't he?" asked Madhu excitedly.

Their mother nodded. "So what it means is that even though we can't change everything, we can each make a big difference by doing little things that matter!"

"I suddenly feel hungry for *maddur vadas* and *chiroti*," declared Mehul smiling broadly.

Make connections

In this section, we will:
- remember details about the story.
- learn how to analyse the structure of a story. (C-2.1, C-2.2)

Map the story

Answer the following questions based on the story.

1. Choose the best option to complete the sentences.
   a. The setting of the story is
      i. Madhu and Mehul's school.
      ii. Madhu and Mehul's home.
      iii. the beach.

rapt: so interested in one thing that you are not aware of anything else

b. The main characters in the story are

i. Madhu, Mehul and their parents

ii. Madhu, Mehul and their teacher

iii. Mehul, the man at the beach and the starfish

c. The conflict or problem in the plot is

i. Madhu and Mehul felt quarrelsome.

ii. Madhu and Mehul felt helpless.

iii. Madhu and Mehul felt bored.

d. The solution to the problem was found when

i. their mother told them a story.

ii. they found starfish on the beach.

iii. they had *maddur vada* and *chiroti*.

e. The narrative is told in third person point of view because it is narrated by

i. Madhu

ii. Mehul

iii. a narrator

f. The story of the starfish is narrated by

i. the father

ii. the mother

iii. the boy at the beach

g. The theme or message of the story is

i. there is no pollution on our planet

ii. we cannot protect our planet

iii. even small actions for the planet matter

2. Choose and write a sentence from the text that reflects the problem in the story. Choose and write a sentence that shows the problem is solved at the end of the story.

Deep dive

Answer the following questions with reference to context.

1. *"Something very wrong has happened and there is nothing we can do about it."*

RECALL	INFER	ANALYSE
a. What had happened that was 'very wrong'? b. How did the 'wrong' thing that happened affect Madhu and Mehul?	c. What do we understand about Madhu and Mehul's characters from their reactions to what had happened?	d. How would you react if you faced a situation you could not change?

2. *"The boy did make a difference, didn't he?" asked Madhu excitedly.*

RECALL	INFER	ANALYSE
a. Who was the boy who made a difference? b. What is the 'difference' that Madhu was talking about?	c. How do you think the story of the boy affected Madhu and Mehul? Give reasons for your answer.	d. Can stories be used to inspire people or change their feelings about something? Explain your answer.

Read, reflect and write

1. What did the children's mother want to teach them through the story that she narrated?
2. What would you do to make a difference to the environment?

Integrate

While plastic is useful, it does not break down naturally like fruit or vegetable peels. But plastic can be recycled (made into other things) or reused. Find ways to reuse common plastic objects that you would otherwise dispose of. Showcase your ideas at school through a mini-exhibition on Parents' Day.

In this section, we will:
- learn about prefixes.
- search for words related to the environment.

(C- 4.1, 4.2)

Word wall

Prefix

A prefix is a group of letters we put before a word.

Examples : un- + usual = unusual
il- + legal = illegal
im- + perfect = imperfect

Note that the new word formed after adding the prefix is the opposite of the base word. This is known as negation.

Choose one of the prefixes il-, im- or un- to add to these words so that they take the opposite meanings.

kind logical happy natural possible literate

Environment words

Find the environment words given in the box in the letter grid below and circle them. Look up the meanings of the words that you do not know. One has been done for you.

recycle reuse pollute conserve extinction preserve deforestation

F	A	R	E	C	Y	C	L	E	L	L	O	T
R	E	C	O	L	R	E	U	S	E	S	T	N
C	S	E	R	V	P	R	E	S	E	R	V	E
C	O	N	S	E	R	V	E	D	E	F	O	R
D	E	F	O	R	E	S	T	A	T	I	O	N
P	O	E	X	T	I	N	C	T	I	O	N	M
P	O	L	L	U	T	E	P	C	R	E	U	S

Make your own sentences with these environment words.

In this section, we will:
- learn to use reported speech. (C-3.4)

Reported speech

Read these sentences.

"I am saving the starfish," said the boy.

The boy said that he was saving the starfish.

What difference do you notice between the two sentences?

The first sentence gives us the **exact words** the boy said. The second sentence **reports or tells** us what the boy said.

ANCHOR CHART

Reported speech: in other words

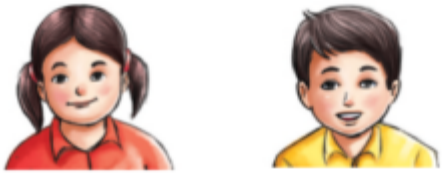
When the speaker's **own words** are used within **quotation marks**, we call it direct speech.

"Father is making *chirotis*," said Mother.

Mother is speaking to Madhu.

We use reported speech to **report** or **tell** someone what another person has said. We do not use quotation marks for reported speech.

Mother said that Father was making *chirotis*.



Madhu told Mehul what Mother said. We always use the **past tense** to report.

Reported speech is also called indirect speech.

1. Use a colour pencil to underline the differences you notice between the sentence pairs.

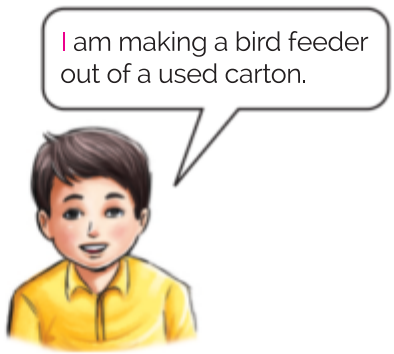
Direct speech	Reported speech
"Grandfather is baking a cake," said Grandmother.	Grandmother said that Grandfather was baking a cake.
Grandmother is repairing the tractor," said Grandfather.	Grandfather said that Grandmother was repairing the tractor.
"The sparrows are chirping," said Mehul.	Mehul said that the sparrows were chirping.
"The sparrows are building a nest," said Madhu.	Madhu said that the sparrows were building a nest.

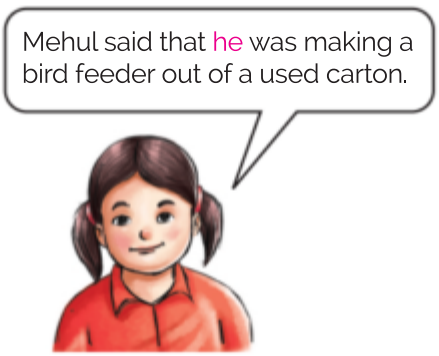
2. The tense often changes when we use reported speech. Fill in the table given below.

Direct speech		Indirect speech
is repairing	changes to	
		was planting
are playing		
		were chirping

Pronouns also change when we use **reported speech**.

I ⟶ he, she
we ⟶ they





2. Match the sentences to get direct–indirect pairs.

A	B
a. 'I am reading,' said Father.	i. Father said that Mother was reading.
b. 'Mother is reading,' said Father.	ii. Father said that they were reading.
c. 'We are reading,' said Father.	iii. Father said that he was reading.
d. 'We are cooking,' said Madhu.	iv. Madhu said that she was cooking.
e. 'I am cooking,' said Madhu.	v. Madhu said that he was cooking.
f. 'He is cooking,' said Madhu.	vi. Madhu said that they were cooking.

3. Fill in the blanks.

a. "The elephant herd is trumpeting," said the forest ranger.

The forest ranger said that the _____.

b. "The bees are buzzing around the beehive," said the beekeeper.

The beekeeper said that the _____ around the beehive.

c. "The Siberian cranes are migrating," said the birdwatcher.

The birdwatcher said that the _____.

d. "The bear is hibernating," said the zookeeper.

The zookeeper said that the _____.

e. "A red panda is climbing the tree," said Grandfather.

Grandfather said that a _____ the tree.

f. "We are learning about endangered animals," said the teacher.

The teacher said that _____ about endangered animals.

Punctuation

In this section, we will:
- practise using punctuation. (C-3.4)

Commas, full stops, capital letters

Punctuate the given lines.

what are fish fish are animals that live and swim in water they have scales fins and gills fish come in different colours shapes and sizes goldfish were first kept as pets in china i have a pet goldfish named sparkle goldfish do not have eyelids so they sleep with their eyes open

In this section, we will:
- write a short informational piece.. (C-3.2, 3.4)

Write well

Giving information

Look at the cause and effect chart given. Write an informational piece on the harmful effects that plastics can cause.

Paragraph 1 should be on the harm plastics can cause on land, paragraph 2 on the harm plastics can cause to marine animals and birds, and paragraph 3 should contain your ideas and suggestions for what we can do to recycle and reduce the use of plastics.

- plastics—widely used—easy and cheap to make—last a long time —not disposed easily—huge pollution problem
- marine creatures eat plastic—mistake plastic for jellyfish—harmful
- more than 10,000 marine animals get entangled in plastic nets—cannot escape
- large areas of land covered in garbage—plastic poisonous to burn
- cattle eat plastic bags—harmful

Cause → Effect

The reason WHY — WHAT happened

Words to show cause and effect:

- *because*
- *due to*
- *so*
- *as a result of*

In this section, we will:
- listen to some questions and mark our scores based on our habits.
- make a presentation about living a greener lifestyle. (C-1.1, 1.2, 1.3)

Listen and speak well

1. Listen carefully to the questions and then circle the number in the column that has your answer. Now, add up your score to find out how much you've got.

Recycling Score Sheet

All the time	Sometimes	Not at all
5	3	0
5	3	0
0	3	5
5	3	0
0	3	5
0	3	5
0	3	5
0	3	5
0	3	5
0	3	5
0	3	5
0	3	5
Total _____	_____	_____

The lower you score, the greener you are.

2. **What did you realize about yourself from the activity you did? Note down ways in which you can improve your lifestyle and make your household greener. Now, give a presentation in class on this topic.**

Remember to not exceed the presentation time of 3 minutes. Keep a note of the following for a good presentation.

During my presentation

I CAN ...

1. Speak clearly.
2. Speak loudly.
3. Look at my audience.
4. Keep my hands and body still.